

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

AUGUST 3, 2026

Talks Resume

Iran-US negotiations set for Monday afternoon per CNBC / TASS lift risk futures and drop crude sharply into the ISM Manufacturing print at 10 AM ET.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE) \$747.03 ↑0.72% · ES fut approx. ↑0.63% pre-mkt per Benzinga / Investing.com	NASDAQ (FRI CLOSE) \$687.99 ↑0.65% · NQ fut approx. ↑0.59% pre-mkt per Benzinga	WTI OVERNIGHT Approx. \$79.54 · ↓approx. 6.06% per Benzinga on Iran talks resumption	BRENT OVERNIGHT Approx. \$83.32 · ↓approx. 5.24% per Benzinga on averted escalation	FEAR & GREED CNN approx. 42 (Fear) per MacroMicro Jul 31 · data drop crypto fallback 28
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Markets — Pre-Open Monday Sets Up as the Iran-US Nuclear and Hormuz Negotiations Are Set to Resume Monday Afternoon per CNBC / TASS / Euronews Coverage of Trump's Announcement That the Planned Attack Had Been Called Off; ES Futures Are Up Approximately 0.63% and Nasdaq 100 Futures Approximately 0.59% per Benzinga / Investing.com Coverage, While Crude Declined Sharply Overnight With WTI ↓approximately 6.06% and Brent ↓approximately 5.24% per Benzinga Pre-Open Data — the ISM Manufacturing PMI Prints at 10 AM ET With Prior 53.3 per ISM June Release

THE PRE-OPEN COMPOSITION REFLECTS THE KINETIC-TO-DIPLOMATIC REPIVOTING CLEANLY — PER BENZINGA / INVESTING.COM PRE-MARKET COVERAGE, S&P 500 FUTURES ARE UP APPROXIMATELY 0.63%, NASDAQ 100 FUTURES APPROXIMATELY 0.59%, AND DOW FUTURES APPROXIMATELY 0.49%, WITH POLYMARKET'S SPX UP-OPEN CONTRACT TRADING NEAR 86% IMPLIED ODDS; THE CRUDE REPRICING HAS BEEN SHARP OVERNIGHT WITH WTI REPORTEDLY APPROXIMATELY ↓6.06% NEAR \$79.54 AND BRENT APPROXIMATELY ↓5.24% NEAR \$83.32 PER BENZINGA PRE-MARKET DATA ON THE WEEKEND IRAN DE-ESCALATION, WITH TRUMP SET TO CONVENE NUCLEAR AND HORMUZ NEGOTIATIONS MONDAY AFTERNOON PER CNBC / TASS / EURONEWS

Per Benzinga and Investing.com pre-market coverage of the Sunday-night sequence, US equity index futures are firming into Monday's open with ES up approximately 0.63%, NQ up approximately 0.59%, and YM up approximately 0.49%, and the Polymarket SPX up-open contract trading near 86% implied odds. Per Benzinga coverage of the weekend crude repricing, WTI reportedly fell approximately 6.06% overnight to near \$79.54 and Brent approximately 5.24% to near \$83.32 on the Iran talks resumption composition. Per data drop reflecting Friday's tape, the S&P 500 closed at \$747.03 (↑0.72%) with an intraday range of \$737.68–\$748.89, the Nasdaq at \$687.99 (↑0.65%), the Dow at \$524.32 (↑0.54%), and the Russell 2K ↓0.48% at \$291.20 — a sector composition that rotated sharply into cyclical as Discretionary (XLY) closed ↑3.29%, Communication Services (XLC) ↑1.56%, Energy (XLE) ↑1.00%, and Industrials (XLI) ↑0.81%, while Materials (XLB) absorbed ↓2.34% into the sharp gold give-back (GLD ↓1.49%, SLV ↓2.13%). For FCI positioning, Monday's open sits at the intersection of the crude complex repricing against the Upstream sleeve rerating (CVX \$196.83 ↑2.35%, CNX \$35.80 ↑3.44%, OKE \$90.81 ↑1.95% Friday per data drop) and a symmetric bid risk into the Growth-cyclical composition that had already set Friday's tape, with the ISM Manufacturing PMI print at 10 AM ET (prior 53.3 per June ISM release) providing the first data catalyst of the session.

ES FUTURES PRE-OPEN	Approx. $\uparrow 0.63\%$ per Benzinga / Investing.com · SPX up-open approx. 86% implied odds Polymarket
NQ FUTURES PRE-OPEN	Approx. $\uparrow 0.59\%$ per Benzinga
WTI OVERNIGHT	Approx. \$79.54 · $\downarrow$ approx. 6.06% per Benzinga on Iran talks
BRENT OVERNIGHT	Approx. \$83.32 · $\downarrow$ approx. 5.24% per Benzinga
IRAN TALKS RESUME	Monday afternoon per CNBC / TASS / Euronews · no deadline set per Reuters
IRAN DENIAL	Tehran denied asking US to hold off & Hormuz split control per Times of Israel
ISM MANUFACTURING PMI	10:00 AM ET Monday · prior 53.3 per June ISM release
PALANTIR Q2 TONIGHT	After close · approx. \$1.812B rev, \$0.34 EPS est per Blockonomi · 8 straight beats per TradingKey
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 active · Fri range \$737.68–\$748.89 · not hit

FRIDAY'S TAPE DELIVERED THE GROWTH-CYCLICAL BID INTO A COMPOSITION ALREADY POSITIONED FOR A MONDAY CONTINUATION SHOULD THE DIPLOMATIC TRAJECTORY HOLD — THE UPSTREAM SLEEVE (CVX $\uparrow 2.35\%$ AT \$196.83, CNX $\uparrow 3.44\%$ AT \$35.80, OKE $\uparrow 1.95\%$ AT \$90.81) FACES THE SHARPEST SYMMETRIC REPRICING RISK INTO THE OVERNIGHT CRUDE DECLINE; THE MERCHANT-SILICON COHORT (NVDA $\uparrow 2.93\%$ AT \$200.75, CRDO $\uparrow 2.94\%$ AT \$206.99, MRVL $\uparrow 2.32\%$ AT \$187.56) RECOVERED MATERIALLY INTO THE AMD PRINT TUESDAY AFTER CLOSE PER AMD

INVESTOR RELATIONS, AND THE UTILITY-AI-POWER SLEEVE (VST \$148.19 $\downarrow 0.29\%$, CEG \$262.75 $\downarrow 0.31\%$, NEE \$86.92 $\downarrow 1.15\%$ FRIDAY) SITS ANCHORED TO LOAD GROWTH RATHER THAN FRONT-MONTH CRUDE

Per data drop, the Upstream sleeve composition — CVX at \$196.83 ($\uparrow 2.35\%$ Friday), CNX at \$35.80 ($\uparrow 3.44\%$), OKE at \$90.81 ($\uparrow 1.95\%$) with OKE also reporting Q2 today pre-market at consensus EPS \$1.4754 — carries the sharpest single-session symmetric risk into the overnight crude repricing that the Iran diplomatic implementation trajectory would deepen. Per AMD Investor Relations, AMD reports Q2 Tuesday, August 4 after the market close with a 5:00 PM ET conference call, and per company guidance revenues of \$11.2B ($\pm \$300M$) at the mid-point represent 46% year-over-year growth, with Wall Street consensus near EPS \$1.34 per Yahoo Finance coverage — a materially large read for the merchant-silicon cohort (NVDA $\uparrow 2.93\%$ at \$200.75, CRDO $\uparrow 2.94\%$ at \$206.99, MRVL $\uparrow 2.32\%$ at \$187.56 Friday per data drop) following Thursday's $\uparrow 13.00\%$ MSFT-driven rip. Per Bloomberg headlines cited across recent coverage, the dollar logged its worst week in over three months last week amid Fed doubts following the 9-3 hawkish hold, the 1.5% Q2 GDP advance per BEA, and June Core PCE cooling to 3.3% year-over-year per BEA. Per data drop, TLT closed Friday at \$82.25 ($\downarrow 0.66\%$) as the long end continued to absorb the higher-for-longer composition. **The physical world matters.**

Monday's pre-open composition validates the weekend's diplomatic pivot with risk futures firming and crude declining sharply per Benzinga pre-market coverage — the Upstream sleeve faces the most direct symmetric repricing risk while the Utility-AI-power sleeve remains anchored to the load-growth thesis rather than front-month crude; the composition reinforces that pre-committed deployment tranches over impulse reaction to a single catalyst window remain the operative FCI framework. Simplicity Over Complexity.

Geopolitics — Iran-US Nuclear and Hormuz Negotiations Are Set to Resume Monday Afternoon per CNBC / TASS / Euronews Coverage of Trump's Sunday Framing on Air Force One, With Trump Describing a Deal as Close-To-Imminent per ABC News; Trump Set No Deadline for a Deal per Reuters, and Tehran's Semi-Official News Agencies on Sunday Denied That Iran Had Asked the US to Hold Off Attacks and Denied Reports of an Agreement to Split Control of the Strait of Hormuz per Times of Israel — the Framework Trump Outlined on Truth Social Calls for a Full Reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and an End to Iran's Nuclear Threat per CNBC / NPR

PER CNBC / TASS / EURONEWS COVERAGE OF THE SUNDAY FRAMING, PRESIDENT TRUMP TOLD REPORTERS ON AIR FORCE ONE THAT NUCLEAR AND HORMUZ TALKS BETWEEN THE US AND IRAN WOULD BEGIN MONDAY AFTERNOON — THE FIRST PUBLICLY ACKNOWLEDGED NEGOTIATIONS SINCE EARLY LAST MONTH PER EURONEWS — AND TRUMP SET NO DEADLINE FOR REACHING A DEAL PER REUTERS; HOWEVER, IRANIAN SEMI-OFFICIAL NEWS AGENCIES ON SUNDAY DENIED BOTH THAT TEHRAN HAD ASKED TRUMP TO HOLD OFF ANY ATTACK AND THAT IT HAD AGREED TO A DEAL SPLITTING CONTROL OF THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ PER TIMES OF ISRAEL COVERAGE OF THE WEEKEND POSITIONING SEQUENCE, AND IRANIAN DIPLOMATIC FRAMING PER PRIOR CNN COVERAGE HAD HELD THAT TEHRAN WAS NOT CURRENTLY NEGOTIATING WITH WASHINGTON — A POSITIONING ASYMMETRY THAT SHARPENS AHEAD OF THE MONDAY SESSION

Per CNBC coverage of the Sunday Air Force One remarks, President Trump indicated that talks with Iran regarding the Strait of Hormuz and nuclear program would commence Monday afternoon, and per Reuters, Trump set no deadline for a deal to be reached. Per ABC News, Trump described a new Iran deal as close-to-imminent on Sunday. Per Euronews, these talks would represent the first publicly acknowledged negotiations since early last month, and the discussions come after Trump called off a planned large-scale strike on Iran that per prior Al-Monitor / CFR coverage had targeted Iranian energy infrastructure including power stations and oil refineries. Per Times of Israel coverage of the Iranian pushback, Tehran's semi-official news agencies on Sunday denied both Trump's claim that Iran had asked the US to hold off attacks and reports that it had agreed to a deal that would divide control of the Strait of Hormuz. Per the framework Trump outlined on Truth Social and reported by CNBC / NPR, the deal architecture calls for a full reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and an end to Iran's nuclear threat. For the FCI Upstream and Defense sleeves, the composition frames a materially wider distribution of Monday-session outcomes than the weekend indicated: a genuine implementation trajectory would reprice the physical crude complex against the Upstream sleeve rerating (CVX \$196.83, CNX \$35.80, OKE \$90.81 Friday per data drop), while an Iranian denial cascade combined with Trump's previously stated warning that attacks would resume absent a deal per NPR carries a symmetric risk of a sharp reversal in the Defense sleeve (LMT \$582.74, GD \$383.42 Friday per data drop). **The physical world matters.**

PER REUTERS COVERAGE REFERENCED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, TWO TANKERS CARRYING SAUDI OIL EXITED THE RED SEA OVER THE WEEKEND — A FIRST SIGNAL THAT PHYSICAL FLOWS MAY BE RE-ROUTING ON THE DIPLOMATIC TRAJECTORY EVEN BEFORE TERMS ARE FINALIZED; SUMED PIPELINE LOADINGS ROSE TO APPROXIMATELY 28.79 MILLION BARRELS IN JULY PER REUTERS FROM APPROXIMATELY 19.52 MILLION IN APRIL PRE-HOUSHI THREAT, AND THE ALTERNATIVE-INFRASTRUCTURE BUILDOUT WOULD NEED TO WORK THROUGH GRADUAL REVERSAL RATHER THAN INSTANT REPRICING SHOULD HORMUZ REOPEN

Per Reuters coverage referenced across the data drop headlines, two tankers carrying Saudi oil exited the Red Sea over the weekend — a physical-flow signal that would be

consistent with an early re-routing composition on the Iran diplomatic trajectory even as the formal implementation framework remains open. Per Reuters analysis referenced across prior briefs, Sumed pipeline loadings (Red Sea to Sidi Kerir on the Mediterranean) rose to approximately 28.79 million barrels in July from approximately 19.52 million in April — before the Houthi July 20 threat to prevent Saudi oil exiting via Bab el-Mandeb — and Chevron's approximately \$12.1B Q2 profit per GuruFocus alongside Shell's approximately \$9.8B Q2 doubling referenced in prior briefs anchor the physical-cash-flow rerating that would need to give back materially should front-month crude reprice sharply lower on validated implementation. Per CNN Live coverage referenced

in the July 31 brief, fewer than 10 commodity ships had cleared Hormuz on a recent Monday morning versus a normal cadence near 100 vessels — the alternative-infrastructure buildout that the crisis triggered would need to work through gradual reversal rather than instant repricing. For FCI positioning, Carson’s SPY support at \$645.80 remains untouched per levels.json at approximately 14% below Friday’s \$748.89 intraday high per data drop — a level that would only come into scope in the event of a sustained downside catalyst sequence rather than a single-session repricing on either side of the Monday talks outcome. **Avoid Erosion.**

IRAN TALKS MONDAY PM	Nuclear + Hormuz per CNBC / TASS / Euronews · first publicly acknowledged since early last month per Euronews
TRUMP FRAMING	Deal described as close-to-imminent per ABC News · no deadline set per Reuters
DEAL FRAMEWORK	Full reopening of Hormuz + end to Iran’s nuclear threat per Truth Social / CNBC / NPR
IRAN DENIAL	Tehran denied asking US to hold off & denied Hormuz-split deal per Times of Israel · Sunday semi-official news agencies
PHYSICAL-FLOW SIGNAL	Two Saudi oil tankers exited Red Sea over weekend per Reuters
ATTACK WARNING	Trump previously said strikes resume if no deal per NPR / The Hill
SUMED (JUL)	Approx. 28.79M bbl vs. approx. 19.52M April per Reuters · gradual reversal not instant
CVX Q2 PROFIT	Approx. \$12.1B per GuruFocus · anchors physical-cash-flow rerating

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. ISM Manufacturing PMI Prints at 10:00 AM ET Monday, With Prior June Reading of 53.3 per the ISM June Release; The Print Provides the First Data Catalyst of the Session Into the Iran Talks Composition and Would Combine With Any Directional Signal From the Monday-Afternoon Nuclear and Hormuz Negotiations per CNBC / TASS to Reset Positioning Materially Into the Balance of the Week. Per the ISM June release, the Manufacturing PMI closed the prior month at 53.3, and the July print lands Monday at 10:00 AM ET per Investing.com week-ahead coverage. Per Investing.com, the S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI forecast for July was near 53.8 per pre-release week-ahead framing, with a preliminary estimate that fell short of expectations of 54.3. For the FCI Dividend and Growth sleeves, the composition — MSFT / AMZN cap-ex validated last week, memory-cost pass-through anchored, and the merchant-silicon cohort well-positioned into Tuesday’s AMD print — keeps the September FOMC genuinely live in either direction, and any material ISM surprise combined with the Iran talks outcome would materially reset the week’s catalyst window. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Palantir (PLTR) Reports Q2 Earnings Tonight After the Close With a 5:00 PM ET Conference Call per BusinessWire / StockTitan — Consensus Near \$1.812B Revenue and \$0.34 Adjusted EPS per Blockonomi Coverage, With 8 Consecutive EPS Beats per TradingKey and an Established Pattern of Post-Print Give-Back (Approximately ↓7% Following Q1 in May per Blockonomi) Despite Beats; The Print Delivers the AI-Platform Growth Read Into a Tape Already Positioned for the Iran Talks Composition and Sets the Tone for the AMD Print Tuesday After Close. Per BusinessWire and StockTitan coverage confirming the release date, Palantir Technologies reports Q2 2026 results Monday, August 3 after the close with a 5:00 PM ET webcast. Per Blockonomi coverage, consensus estimates near \$1.812B in revenue (approximately ↑80% year-over-year) and adjusted EPS near \$0.34, with TradingKey noting 8 consecutive quarterly EPS beats. Per Blockonomi, Palantir shares fell approximately 7% following the Q1 print in May despite a beat, establishing a pattern where operational execution has not translated to positive post-print returns. The PLTR print delivers the AI-platform read into a tape sitting between the weekend Iran de-escalation and Tuesday’s AMD report, and the composition would combine with the ISM PMI signal at 10 AM ET to set the AI-adjacent cohort’s tone into the balance of the week. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. AMD Reports Q2 2026 Tuesday, August 4 After the Market Close With a 5:00 PM ET Conference Call per AMD Investor Relations — Company Guidance Points to Approximately \$11.2B (±\$300M) in Revenue Representing Approximately 46% Year-Over-Year Growth at the Mid-Point, With Wall Street Consensus Near EPS \$1.34 per Yahoo Finance / Zacks Coverage; The Print Delivers the Merchant-Silicon Read Into a Composition Where the Cohort Recovered Materially Friday (NVDA ↑2.93%, CRDO ↑2.94%, MRVL ↑2.32% per Data Drop) After Thursday's ↑13.00% MSFT-Driven Rip.

Per AMD Investor Relations, AMD reports fiscal Q2 2026 Tuesday, August 4 after the market close with a 5:00 PM ET / 2:00 PM PT conference call. Per company guidance referenced in Yahoo Finance / Hudson Labs coverage, AMD expects Q2 revenue of \$11.2B (±\$300M), representing approximately 46% year-over-year growth at the mid-point and approximately 9% sequential growth. Per Yahoo / Zacks coverage, Wall Street consensus centers near EPS \$1.34, up materially from \$0.27 in the year-ago quarter. Per data drop, AMD closed Friday ↓1.90% at \$476.15 after Thursday's ↑13.00% MSFT-driven rip, and the merchant-silicon cohort (NVDA \$200.75 ↑2.93%, CRDO \$206.99 ↑2.94%, MRVL \$187.56 ↑2.32% per data drop) recovered materially into the print. The AMD read will provide the data-center accelerator demand signal, the memory-cost pass-through composition that AAPL and AMZN both flagged last week, and the merchant-silicon competitive positioning against NVDA. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

4. FCI Cohort Reporting Today Pre-Market Includes OKE at Consensus EPS \$1.4754 per Data Drop — The Q2 Print Delivers the Midstream Read Into a Composition Where OKE Closed Friday ↑1.95% at \$90.81 per Data Drop Into the Physical-Flow Positioning That the Iran Diplomatic Trajectory Would Reprice; A Beat Alongside Constructive Volume / Fee-Based Guidance Would Anchor the Sleeve, While a Guide Reset on the Refined-Product Line Composition Combined With the Overnight Crude Decline Would Sit Against the FCI Upstream and Midstream Sleeve Rerating That Chevron's Approximately \$12.1B Q2 Profit per GuruFocus Underpinned.

Per data drop, OKE is the sole FCI holding reporting Q2 today pre-market at consensus EPS \$1.4754. Per data drop, OKE closed Friday at \$90.81 (↑1.95%) into the print, with the broader Upstream / Midstream sleeve composition — CVX \$196.83 (↑2.35%), CNX \$35.80 (↑3.44%) — reflecting the physical-cash-flow rerating that the July kinetic sequence anchored. For FCI positioning, the OKE print alongside the overnight crude decline per Benzinga pre-market data would frame the midstream / gathering-and-processing composition into the balance of the Iran talks trajectory, and a constructive

volume and fee-based guide would anchor the sleeve against front-month crude repricing risk on the diplomatic implementation. *The physical world matters.*

5. Week Ahead — Vistra (VST) Reports Q2 Friday, August 7 Pre-Market With a 10:00 AM ET Conference Call per StockTitan; Analyst Consensus Near \$2.02 EPS and Approximately \$6.29B Revenue per Yahoo Finance Coverage — Materially Below Prior Barchart Framing of Approximately \$2.43 EPS, With the Dispersion Reflecting the Load-Growth / Hyperscaler-Contracting Read Uncertainty; The Same Friday Session Delivers the July Nonfarm Payrolls Release at 8:30 AM ET per BLS Schedule, With Prior June Print of +57,000 Jobs per Trading Economics Framing a Materially Live September FOMC Meeting. Per StockTitan coverage confirming the release,

Vistra reports Q2 2026 Friday, August 7 pre-market with a 10:00 AM ET call. Per Yahoo Finance coverage, consensus centers near \$2.02 EPS and approximately \$6.29B in revenue — below Barchart's prior framing near \$2.43 EPS — with the dispersion reflecting the load-growth capture and hyperscaler-contracting cadence uncertainty into the print. Per data drop, the Utility-AI-power cohort composition — VST \$148.19 ↓0.29%, CEG \$262.75 ↓0.31%, NEE \$86.92 ↓1.15% Friday — gave back modestly against the growth-cyclical rotation. Per BLS release schedule, the July nonfarm payrolls report lands Friday, August 7 at 8:30 AM ET into a labor context where June printed +57,000 jobs per Trading Economics. Any material NFP surprise combined with the VST print delivers the Utility-AI-power sleeve's crystallization into a materially eventful Friday-morning session. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

6. Carson's SPY Support at \$645.80 Remains Untouched Through Friday's \$737.68–\$748.89 Intraday Range per Data Drop and levels.json — The Retracement Target Sits Approximately 14% Below the Current Tape; The Iran Diplomatic Pivot Combined With the Overnight Crude Decline per Benzinga Pre-Market Coverage, the ISM Manufacturing PMI Print at 10:00 AM ET, the Palantir Q2 After Close, and Tuesday's AMD Print Sets the Monday-to-Tuesday Sequence as a Materially Dense Catalyst Window — the Pre-Committed Deployment Tranches (70% of Reserves at –25% Drawdown, Remaining 30% at –40%) Remain the Operative FCI Discipline Into That Sequence. Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 — the retracement target set April 13 — remains

untouched through Friday's \$737.68–\$748.89 intraday range per data drop and sits approximately 14% below the current tape. The prior major resistance zone at \$691.90–\$693.20 was cleared on April 14 per levels.json and is not a live reference point. For the FCI risk framework, the Monday-to-Tuesday sequence — overnight crude decline per Benzinga, Iran talks Monday afternoon per CNBC / TASS, ISM Manufacturing PMI at 10:00 AM ET, OKE Q2 pre-market, Palantir Q2 after close, AMD Q2 Tuesday after close — is

materially dense on the catalyst calendar, and the pre-committed deployment tranches (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) remain the operative discipline through the sequence rather than any impulse response to a single-catalyst repricing. *Avoid Erosion.*